

IN PROFILE

The Sitwells

From about 1915 to 1930, the three siblings of the aristocratic Sitwell family, Edith, Osbert, and Sacheverell, became known in London “society” as the center of a circle of upper-class, fashionable young people with literary and artistic pretensions. Each of the Sitwells achieved modest success and a brief period in the limelight: Edith as a poet (see main text), Osbert as a writer and art critic, and Sacheverell as a music and art historian. However, unlike the contemporary and greatly revered Bloomsbury Group (to which they are sometimes compared), the Sitwells’ fame was largely built on notoriety and eccentricity rather than on artistic merit.



PORTRAIT OF EDITH
SITWELL, ROGER FRY,
1915

William Walton was born in Oldham, Lancashire, in 1902. Although not well off, his family was musical and soon